

Ninety-Three Per Cent of a Backlog Is Not a Backlog: Reading a Public Publisher's Own Quality Signal

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Declarations

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Competing interests. The author declares none.

Ethics approval. Not applicable. The study involves no human participants, no animal subjects and no personal data; it analyses published national legislation and its publisher's own metadata.

Declaration of generative AI use. *Tool:* Claude Opus 5 (Anthropic). *How it was used:* to write the collection, analysis, verification and figure scripts that produce every number reported here, to draft and revise the manuscript, and to run adversarial checks against its own claims. *Reason for use:* the study required retrieving and parsing the metadata of the entire modern statute book under a five-second crawl delay and auditing the result, which is not feasible by hand at that scale for a single researcher. The author set the research question, directed the analysis, verified the outputs against the underlying records, and is responsible for the content.

CRedit roles. A. Almohammed: conceptualisation, data curation, methodology, software, formal analysis, investigation, writing — original draft, writing — review and editing.

Data availability. The collection, the analysis and the scripts that reproduce every number and figure are openly available at <https://github.com/Abdullah-m7/saudi-legal-corpus-ai>. The underlying metadata belongs to legislation.gov.uk and is published by the Crown under the Open Government Licence.

A note on the subject. This article measures a defect that legislation.gov.uk discloses about itself. It is not an accusation. Almost no comparable publisher discloses as much, which is what makes the measurement possible at all, and the article's argument is that disclosure of this quality still leaves a reader unable to answer the question it raises.

Vitae

Abdullah Almohammedy studies a question most legal research takes for granted: whether a state's own published law can be relied upon. To answer it he built the Saudi Legal Corpus, an open article-level record of Saudi Arabian legislation in which every verified article carries the sources it was reconciled from, and uses it to measure availability, consistency and amendment in the official record. He is an independent researcher based in Jeddah, trained in law, and publishes the data and code behind every figure he reports.

A passport-type photograph of the author accompanies this submission as a separate file: `Almohammedy_photo.jpg`.